

VOCABULARY · EXAMPLES · ACTIVITIES

ANIMAL LOVERS

El diccionario de los animales

A pocket dictionary for young animal lovers
with Spain 🇪🇸 and Argentina 🇦🇷 words

PONCHO
SPANISH

¡HOLA, AMANTE DE LOS ANIMALES!

Do you love dogs, cats, horses or dolphins? Then you already have the best reason to learn Spanish: talking about the animals you love.

Inside you'll find more than 80 animal words, each with a real example sentence. There are pets, farm animals, wild animals, sea creatures and creepy-crawlies, plus the words you need to look after an animal.

At the end there are activities to check what you remember, and you'll discover what animals 'say' in Spanish. Spoiler: a Spanish dog doesn't say 'woof'!

How to use it

1. **Read the word, then the sentence.** Words stick better when you see them in action.
2. **Say it out loud.** Try it with your pet listening!
3. **Draw it.** Make a poster of your favourite animals with their Spanish names.
4. **Try the activities** without looking back, then check the answers.

Two countries, two words

Spanish is spoken in more than 20 countries, and some animal words change from place to place. When you see two options, the first is common in Spain 🇪🇸 and the second in Argentina 🇦🇷. Both are correct.

la mariquita 🇪🇸 = **la vaquita de San Antonio** 🇦🇷

Boy or girl?

Many animals change their ending: **el gato** (boy cat), **la gata** (girl cat); **el perro**, **la perra**. Some have one word for both: **la jirafa** is always **la**, even if it's a boy giraffe!

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01

LAS MASCOTAS

PETS

The furry, feathery and scaly friends who share our homes.

ESPAÑOL	ENGLISH	EN UNA FRASE
la mascota	the pet	*¿Tienes mascota?* Have you got a pet?
el perro / la perra	the dog	*Mi perro se llama Toby.* My dog is called Toby.
el cachorro	the puppy	*El cachorro duerme todo el día.* The puppy sleeps all day.
el gato / la gata	the cat	*La gata duerme en mi cama.* The cat sleeps on my bed.
el gatito	the kitten	*¡Qué gatito tan pequeño!* What a tiny kitten!
el conejo	the rabbit	*El conejo come zanahorias.* The rabbit eats carrots.
el hámster	the hamster	*Mi hámster corre en su rueda.* My hamster runs on its wheel.
el conejillo de Indias 🇪🇸 el cuis 🇦🇷	the guinea pig	*El conejillo de Indias hace ruiditos.* The guinea pig makes little noises.
el pez / los peces	the fish	*Tenemos tres peces de colores.* We have three goldfish.
la tortuga	the tortoise, the turtle	*La tortuga camina muy despacio.* The tortoise walks very slowly.
el loro	the parrot	*Nuestro loro dice '¡hola!'.* Our parrot says 'hello!'.

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01 · LAS MASCOTAS PETS

ESPAÑOL	ENGLISH	EN UNA FRASE
el periquito	the budgie	*El periquito es azul y verde.* The budgie is blue and green.
la jaula	the cage	*Limpia la jaula los sábados.* Clean the cage on Saturdays.
la correa	the lead	*Pon la correa al perro.* Put the dog's lead on.
la caseta 🇪🇸 la cucha 🇦🇷	the kennel, the dog bed	*El perro está en su caseta.* The dog is in his kennel.

¿SABÍAS QUE...?

Spanish has two words for fish: el pez is the animal swimming in your tank and el pescado is the fish on your plate. So you'd never want to eat your peces de colores!

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02

EN LA GRANJA

ON THE FARM

The animals that wake up with the sun and the farmers who look after them.

ESPAÑOL	ENGLISH	EN UNA FRASE
la granja	the farm	*Mis abuelos viven en una granja.* My grandparents live on a farm.
la vaca	the cow	*La vaca nos da leche.* The cow gives us milk.
el toro	the bull	*El toro es muy fuerte.* The bull is very strong.
el caballo	the horse	*Me encanta montar a caballo.* I love riding horses.
el burro	the donkey	*El burro tiene orejas largas.* The donkey has long ears.
el cerdo 🇪🇸 el chancho 🇦🇷	the pig	*El cerdo está lleno de barro.* The pig is covered in mud.
la oveja	the sheep	*Las ovejas comen hierba.* The sheep eat grass.
la cabra	the goat	*La cabra sube a las rocas.* The goat climbs the rocks.
la gallina	the hen	*La gallina pone un huevo cada día.* The hen lays an egg every day.
el gallo	the cockerel	*El gallo canta por la mañana.* The cockerel crows in the morning.
el pollito	the chick	*Los pollitos son amarillos.* The chicks are yellow.

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02 · EN LA GRANJA ON THE FARM

ESPAÑOL	ENGLISH	EN UNA FRASE
el pato	the duck	*El pato nada en el estanque.* The duck swims in the pond.
el granjero / la granjera	the farmer	*La granjera da de comer a los animales.* The farmer feeds the animals.
el establo	the stable, the barn	*Los caballos duermen en el establo.* The horses sleep in the stable.

¿SABÍAS QUE...?

In Argentina's countryside, gauchos have looked after cattle on horseback for hundreds of years. Their horses are famous, and the criollo horse is known for being strong enough to travel huge distances.

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03

ANIMALES SALVAJES

WILD ANIMALS

From the savannah to the jungle and the snowy mountains.

ESPAÑOL	ENGLISH	EN UNA FRASE
el león / la leona	the lion / the lioness	*El león es el rey de la selva.* The lion is the king of the jungle.
el tigre	the tiger	*El tigre tiene rayas negras.* The tiger has black stripes.
el elefante	the elephant	*El elefante tiene una trompa larga.* The elephant has a long trunk.
la jirafa	the giraffe	*La jirafa tiene el cuello muy largo.* The giraffe has a very long neck.
el mono	the monkey	*El mono salta de árbol en árbol.* The monkey jumps from tree to tree.
el oso	the bear	*El oso duerme en invierno.* The bear sleeps in winter.
el lobo	the wolf	*El lobo aúlla a la luna.* The wolf howls at the moon.
el zorro	the fox	*El zorro es muy listo.* The fox is very clever.
la serpiente 🇪🇸 la víbora 🇦🇷	the snake	*La serpiente se esconde en la hierba.* The snake hides in the grass.
el cocodrilo	the crocodile	*El cocodrilo tiene muchos dientes.* The crocodile has lots of teeth.
el carpincho 🇦🇷	the capybara	*El carpincho es el roedor más grande del mundo.* The capybara is the biggest rodent in the world.

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03 · ANIMALES SALVAJES WILD ANIMALS

ESPAÑOL	ENGLISH	EN UNA FRASE
el yaguareté 🇦🇷	the jaguar	*El yaguareté vive en la selva del norte argentino.* The jaguar lives in the jungle of northern Argentina.
el lince ibérico 🇪🇸	the Iberian lynx	*El lince ibérico vive en el sur de España.* The Iberian lynx lives in southern Spain.
el cóndor	the condor	*El cóndor vuela sobre los Andes.* The condor flies over the Andes.
en peligro de extinción	endangered	*El lince está en peligro de extinción.* The lynx is endangered.

¿Sabías que...?

The capybara, el carpincho, is the world's biggest rodent: it can weigh as much as an adult person! Capybaras love water and are so calm that birds often sit on their backs.

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04

EN EL MAR

IN THE SEA

Creatures of the oceans, rivers and rock pools.

ESPAÑOL	ENGLISH	EN UNA FRASE
el mar	the sea	*Me encanta nadar en el mar.* I love swimming in the sea.
el delfín	the dolphin	*Los delfines saltan fuera del agua.* Dolphins jump out of the water.
la ballena	the whale	*La ballena es enorme.* The whale is enormous.
el tiburón	the shark	*El tiburón tiene una aleta en la espalda.* The shark has a fin on its back.
el pulpo	the octopus	*El pulpo tiene ocho brazos.* The octopus has eight arms.
la medusa 🇪🇸 el aguaviva 🇦🇷	the jellyfish	*¡Cuidado, hay medusas en la playa!* Careful, there are jellyfish on the beach!
el cangrejo	the crab	*El cangrejo camina de lado.* The crab walks sideways.
la estrella de mar	the starfish	*Encontré una estrella de mar en las rocas.* I found a starfish on the rocks.
la foca	the seal	*Las focas toman el sol en la playa.* The seals sunbathe on the beach.
el pingüino	the penguin	*Los pingüinos viven en la Patagonia.* Penguins live in Patagonia.
la tortuga marina	the sea turtle	*La tortuga marina pone huevos en la arena.* The sea turtle lays eggs in the sand.

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04 · EN EL MAR IN THE SEA

ESPAÑOL	ENGLISH	EN UNA FRASE
la aleta	the fin, the flipper	*El delfín mueve la aleta.* The dolphin moves its fin.
nadar	to swim	*Los peces nadan muy rápido.* Fish swim really fast.
bucear	to dive, to snorkel	*Buceamos para ver los peces.* We snorkelled to see the fish.

¿SABÍAS QUE...?

Every year southern right whales visit Península Valdés in Argentina to have their babies, and you can watch them from the beach. In Argentina a jellyfish is un aguaviva, which means 'living water'!

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05

BICHOS Y PÁJAROS

BUGS AND BIRDS

Tiny creatures with six legs, eight legs or lots of feathers.

ESPAÑOL	ENGLISH	EN UNA FRASE
el bicho	the bug, the creepy-crawly	*¡Hay un bicho en mi zapato!* There's a bug in my shoe!
la mariposa	the butterfly	*La mariposa tiene alas de colores.* The butterfly has colourful wings.
la abeja	the bee	*Las abejas hacen miel.* Bees make honey.
la hormiga	the ant	*Las hormigas trabajan en equipo.* Ants work as a team.
la araña	the spider	*La araña teje su tela.* The spider spins its web.
la mariquita 🇪🇸 la vaquita de San Antonio 🇦🇷	the ladybird	*Una mariquita en mi mano.* A ladybird on my hand.
el caracol	the snail	*El caracol lleva su casa a cuestas.* The snail carries its house on its back.
el mosquito	the mosquito	*¡Me ha picado un mosquito!* A mosquito has bitten me!
el gusano	the worm	*El pájaro come un gusano.* The bird eats a worm.
el pájaro	the bird	*Los pájaros cantan en el jardín.* The birds sing in the garden.
el búho	the owl	*El búho sale por la noche.* The owl comes out at night.

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05 · BICHOS Y PÁJAROS BUGS AND BIRDS

ESPAÑOL	ENGLISH	EN UNA FRASE
el águila	the eagle	*El águila vuela muy alto.* The eagle flies very high.
el nido	the nest	*Hay tres huevos en el nido.* There are three eggs in the nest.
las plumas	the feathers	*El loro tiene plumas verdes.* The parrot has green feathers.
el hornero 🇦🇷	the ovenbird	*El hornero hace su nido de barro.* The ovenbird builds its nest out of mud.

¿SABÍAS QUE...?

Argentina's national bird is el hornero, the ovenbird. It builds a round nest out of mud that looks like a little clay oven, un horno, which is how it got its name.

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06

CUIDAR A UN ANIMAL

LOOKING AFTER AN ANIMAL

What animals need, how they move and how we take care of them.

ESPAÑOL	ENGLISH	EN UNA FRASE
dar de comer	to feed	*Le doy de comer al gato dos veces al día.* I feed the cat twice a day.
sacar a pasear	to take for a walk	*Saco a pasear al perro después del cole.* I walk the dog after school.
acariciar	to stroke	*Me gusta acariciar al conejo.* I like stroking the rabbit.
cepillar	to brush	*Cepillo al perro los domingos.* I brush the dog on Sundays.
el veterinario / la veterinaria	the vet	*Llevamos al gato al veterinario.* We took the cat to the vet.
el agua	water	*El perro necesita agua fresca.* The dog needs fresh water.
el pienso 🇪🇸 el alimento balanceado 🇦🇷	pet food (dry)	*Compramos pienso para el perro.* We bought dog food.
ladrar	to bark	*Mi perro ladra al cartero.* My dog barks at the postman.
maullar	to miaow	*El gato maúlla cuando tiene hambre.* The cat miaows when it's hungry.
morder	to bite	*Este perro no muerde.* This dog doesn't bite.
la cola	the tail	*El perro mueve la cola.* The dog wags its tail.

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06 · CUIDAR A UN ANIMAL LOOKING AFTER AN ANIMAL

ESPAÑOL	ENGLISH	EN UNA FRASE
la pata	the paw, the leg	*El gato tiene una pata blanca.* The cat has one white paw.
el pelo	the fur	*Mi gato tiene el pelo muy suave.* My cat has really soft fur.
adoptar	to adopt	*Adoptamos a nuestra perra en un refugio.* We adopted our dog from a shelter.

¿SABÍAS QUE...?

In Spanish, people have piernas but animals have patas. And if someone metió la pata, they didn't step in anything: it means they made a blunder!

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07

¿QUÉ DICEN LOS ANIMALES?

ANIMAL SOUNDS

Animals 'speak' differently in every language. Here's how they sound in Spanish. Read them out loud!

El perro: ¡guau, guau!
The dog: woof woof!

El gato: ¡miau!
The cat: miaow!

La vaca: ¡muuu!
The cow: moo!

El gallo: ¡quiquiriquí!
The cockerel: cock-a-doodle-doo!

El pato: ¡cuac, cuac!
The duck: quack quack!

La oveja: ¡beee!
The sheep: baa!

El cerdo: ¡oinc, oinc!
The pig: oink oink!

El pollito: ¡pío, pío!
The chick: cheep cheep!

El león: ¡grrr!
The lion: roar!

El burro: ¡iii-aaa!
The donkey: hee-haw!

El caballo: ¡iiiiih!
The horse: neigh!

La abeja: ¡bzzz!
The bee: buzz!

¿SABÍAS QUE...?

In Spanish, the sound a dog makes has its own verb, ladrar, and so does a cat, maullar. A cow muge, a horse relincha and a bird pía. Can you make all the sounds?

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08

¡A JUGAR!

ACTIVITIES

1 MATCH THEM UP

Write the letter of the English meaning next to each Spanish word or phrase.

1	el perro	☐	A	the cow
2	la vaca	☐	B	the owl
3	el caballo	☐	C	the rabbit
4	la ballena	☐	D	the dog
5	la abeja	☐	E	the tortoise
6	el búho	☐	F	the bee
7	el conejo	☐	G	the spider
8	la araña	☐	H	the horse
9	el pulpo	☐	I	the octopus
10	la tortuga	☐	J	the whale

2 ¿VERDADERO O FALSO?

Read each sentence and circle V (true) or F (false).

1. El pulpo tiene ocho brazos. **V** **F**
2. Las abejas hacen leche. **V** **F**
3. El carpincho es un roedor muy grande. **V** **F**
4. El gallo canta por la noche. **V** **F**
5. En Argentina, la mariquita se llama vaquita de San Antonio. **V** **F**
6. Un perro dice '¡miau!' en español. **V** **F**

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3 MY PET

Complete Lucía's description of her dog with the words from the box.

perra | pelo | cola | pasear | comer | ladra | veterinaria | adoptamos

Tengo una _____ que se llama Luna. La _____ en un refugio hace dos años. Tiene el _____ marrón y muy suave, y siempre mueve la _____ cuando llego a casa. Por la mañana le doy de _____ y por la tarde la saco a _____. Luna _____ cuando ve un gato. Una vez al año vamos a la _____.

4 SPAIN OR ARGENTINA?

Write the word used in Argentina next to the one used in Spain.

- **el cerdo** → _____
- **la mariquita** → _____
- **la medusa** → _____
- **la serpiente** → _____
- **el pienso** → _____
- **el conejillo de Indias** → _____
- **la caseta** → _____

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5 SOPA DE LETRAS

Find the 12 words. They go across → or down ↓.

E	R	O	L	B	C	T	U	L	L	M	V
R	U	P	E	C	C	I	R	C	B	J	U
P	J	N	O	M	O	P	E	R	R	O	A
C	P	M	N	F	S	V	L	D	R	B	G
A	J	E	H	N	O	N	O	L	O	R	O
B	R	C	F	P	N	T	B	I	E	O	T
R	G	A	T	O	F	I	O	O	M	N	H
A	E	C	F	E	O	H	H	A	R	U	F
I	P	A	T	O	C	V	A	C	A	M	J
A	B	E	J	A	A	A	E	O	T	O	M
V	U	L	E	S	V	B	P	T	N	N	N
N	N	D	R	N	B	G	C	G	P	O	F

PERRO

GATO

VACA

LEON

OSO

PATO

MONO

LOBO

ABEJA

FOCA

LORO

CABRA

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6 MY FAVOURITE ANIMAL

Write about your favourite animal, real or imaginary, in four or five sentences: what it is, where it lives, what it looks like, what it eats and why you love it. Use at least five words from this dictionary.

Try: Mi animal favorito es... Vive en... Tiene... Come... Me encanta porque...

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ANSWERS

1 · MATCH THEM UP

1–D, 2–A, 3–H, 4–J, 5–F, 6–B, 7–C, 8–G, 9–I, 10–E

2 · ¿VERDADERO O FALSO?

1 V, 2 F, 3 V, 4 F, 5 V, 6 F

3 · MY PET

1. perra, 2. adoptamos, 3. pelo, 4. cola, 5. comer, 6. pasear, 7. ladra, 8. veterinaria

4 · SPAIN OR ARGENTINA?

el cerdo → el chancho; la mariquita → la vaquita de San Antonio; la medusa → el aguaviva; la serpiente → la víbora; el pienso → el alimento balanceado; el conejillo de Indias → el cuis; la caseta → la cucha

6 · MY FAVOURITE ANIMAL

Any answer that uses five words from the dictionary is a winner. Draw your animal next to it!

5 · SOPA DE LETRAS

E	R	O	L	B	C	T	U	L	L	M	V
R	U	P	E	C	C	I	R	C	B	J	U
P	J	N	O	M	O	P	E	R	R	O	A
C	P	M	N	F	S	V	L	D	R	B	G
A	J	E	H	N	O	N	O	L	O	R	O
B	R	C	F	P	N	T	B	I	E	O	T
R	G	A	T	O	F	I	O	O	M	N	H
A	E	C	F	E	O	H	H	A	R	U	F
I	P	A	T	O	C	V	A	C	A	M	J
A	B	E	J	A	A	A	E	O	T	O	M
V	U	L	E	S	V	B	P	T	N	N	N
N	N	D	R	N	B	G	C	G	P	O	F

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¡MUY BIEN!

YOU DID IT

Now you can talk about animals in Spanish. Next time you see a dog, a bird or a bee, say its name in Spanish and see how many you remember.

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SPANISH

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